

PERSISTENCE OF MEN'S MISPERCEPTIONS OF FRIENDLY CUES ACROSS A VARIETY OF INTERPERSONAL ENCOUNTERS

Catherine B. Johnson, Margaret S. Stockdale, and
Frank E. Saal
Kansas State University

This study examined whether gender differences in sexually based perceptions of social interactions persist when traditional male-female power roles are reversed, when the interaction becomes progressively more sexually harassing, and when the response to the harassment is accepting or rejecting. A laboratory experiment was conducted in which 187 female and 165 male undergraduate students viewed a 5-minute videotape. Twelve versions of a scenario depicting a professor interacting with a cross-sex student were created which manipulated the sex of the powerholder, level of harassment, and response to harassment. Results indicated that men perceived the female target as behaving in a "sexier" manner regardless of her status, the level of harassment, or the victim's response. Women's sexually based perceptions of the most harassing male professor were greater than men's, however. Incorporating these gender differences in perceptions into a much-needed comprehensive model of sexual harassment (Zedeck & Cascio, 1984) appears to be warranted.

The pervasiveness of sexual harassment in business, industry, government, academia, and the military is widely documented (e.g., Dzech & Weiner, 1984; Glaser & Thorpe, 1986; MacKinnon, 1979; Meyer, Berchtold, Oestreich, & Collins, 1981; Pope, Levenson, & Schover, 1979; Rogan, 1981; State of Illinois, 1980; U.S. Merit Systems Protection Board, 1981). Because working definitions of sexual harassment rely so heavily on subject-

The first two authors contributed equally to this research.

Address reprint requests to: Margaret Stockdale, Psychology Department, Southern Illinois University, Carbondale, IL 62901.

tive perceptions (e.g., behavior that is objectionable or offensive to one person may not be so to another), differences in the way women and men view social exchanges in the workplace or at school are potentially important components of an emerging model of sexual harassment.

Women's threshold for labeling particular behaviors as harassment appears to be lower than men's (Abbey, 1987; Gutek, Morasch, & Cohen, 1983; Gutek, Nakamura, Gahart, Handschumacher, & Russell, 1980; Kenig & Ryan, 1986; Padgitt & Padgitt, 1986; Powell, 1986; Reilly, Lott, & Gallogy, 1986; Shotland & Craig, 1988; U.S. Merit Systems Protection Board, 1981). Women are more likely than men to consider sexual teasing, jokes, looks, gestures, unnecessary physical contact, or remarks from a coworker or supervisor to be acts of sexual harassment. Women are also more likely to view sexual behavior in the workplace as a form of sexual exploitation and as less acceptable than are men (Gutek & Dunwoody, 1987; Padgitt & Padgitt, 1986; Powell, 1986). Similarly, female managers are more likely than their male colleagues to believe that sexual harassment is a problem, and more likely to label vignettes of male-female interactions as harassment (Collins & Blodgett, 1981). Although men may view male-female interactions as more sexual than women do (Abbey, 1982; Abbey & Melby, 1986; Collins & Blodgett, 1981; Saal, Johnson, & Weber, 1989; Shotland & Craig, 1988), they also believe such behaviors are more normative and acceptable in the workplace (Gutek et al., 1983).

Past research has indicated that men are more likely than women to ascribe responsibility for a sexual harassment incident to the female victim (Kenig & Ryan, 1986; U.S. Merit Systems Protection Board, 1981). In addition to serving a defensive function (Jensen & Gutek, 1982), some research suggests that such "blaming the victim" behavior may be attributable to a tendency among men to perceive women's friendly behavior as a sign of sexual interest or availability (Abbey, 1982; Abbey & Melby, 1986; Saal et al., 1989).

This tendency for men compared to women to perceive interactions that occur in social, academic, and business settings in more sexual terms may be an important interpersonal component in an emerging model of sexual harassment. When women attempt to create a friendly atmosphere at work or school, their behavior may be (mis)interpreted by men as a sign of sexual interest or availability. Men may then act on these (mis)perceptions in a way that is offensive to women and that women label as sexual harassment.

Abbey (1982) tested the hypothesis that men misperceive women's intentions with an empirical investigation that involved male and female subjects observing 5-minute interactions between mixed-sex pairs. Compared to women, men tended to view the female actor as significantly more promiscuous and seductive and as more sexually attracted to and anxious to date the male actor. Men were also more sexually attracted to the other-sex actor than were women. In a later study, Abbey and Melby

(1986) asked subjects to rate photographs of men and women engaged in varying levels of eye contact, touch, and interpersonal distance. They also found that men, compared to women, rated the female "targets" as more sexy, promiscuous, and seductive. Men were also more sexually attracted to the other-sex target than were women.

In a replication and extension of Abbey's (1982) study to business and academic environments, Saal et al. (1989) found additional support for Abbey's conclusion that men perceive mixed-sex interactions in more sexual terms than do women. Men were more likely to view three different interactions in more sexual terms than women: informal "get-acquainted" discussions between a female student and a male student, a male manager training a female cashier, and a male professor discussing an extension of a project with a female student. Men thought the female actor or target was trying to be more seductive, more promiscuous, more sexy, more flirtatious, and less friendly than did women.

Saal et al. (1989) suggested that men's thresholds for perceiving sexuality in women's behavior may be reached more easily than women's thresholds. As a woman's behavior becomes more friendly and outgoing when she acclimates to her work or academic environment, men may be quicker to label her behavior as "sexy" and then to respond in ways that the woman construes as sexually harassing.

The purpose of this experiment was to examine the robustness and generality of gender differences in perceptions when social interactions become progressively more sexually harassing and when the response to the harassment varies. If these gender differences in perceptions persist, they may warrant further attention as a potential component of a comprehensive model of sexual harassment.

This study examined whether men continue to see more sexual intent than women when social interactions become more sexually suggestive, and when the victim declines the perpetrator's overture. If men's misperceptions persist under these conditions, this would constitute even stronger evidence that such misperceptions may be active components in sexual harassment behavior. This study also examined the less familiar situation of a (more powerful) female professor who makes the overture to a (less powerful) male student to determine whether similar misperceptions ensue. This study goes beyond previous studies of gender differences in perceptions because it (a) disentangles the effects of status and gender by having both the man and woman in student and professor roles, (b) examines mildly and moderately sexually suggestive situations as well as "purely" friendly or professional situations, and (c) examines the effect of the victim's response to the interaction. The outcome of the study speaks further to the pervasiveness of men's misperceptions.

Consistent with previous research, men (compared to women) were expected to view the female student as trying to behave in a "sexier" manner across all harassment conditions (i.e., nonharassing, mildly ha-

rassing, and moderately harassing). Gender differences in perceptions of the male student were difficult to predict due to the paucity of research with men in subordinate roles. Additionally, the effect of the response of the victim on perceptions is an exploratory area of research.

METHOD

Participants

Participants were 187 female and 165 male Kansas State University undergraduate students who participated in the experiment for course credit. They ranged in age from 17 to 37 years ($M = 21.26$).

Procedure

Participants viewed a 5-minute videotape depicting a professor and student discussing an extension of the deadline for submitting a term paper. Students were (mis)informed that they were viewing the videotape to assess the extent to which nonverbal communication facilitates or detracts from effective oral communication in various settings. Each student saw 1 of 12 versions of the scenario: half depicted a male professor interacting with a female student and half depicted a female professor interacting with a male student. The same actors appeared in all scenarios.

In each scenario, the professor displayed one of three levels of harassment behavior (none, mild, or moderate),¹ and the student responded in one of two ways (rejecting or accepting). In the nonharassing condition, the professor offered the student several reference books for help with the term paper. In the mildly harassing condition, the professor suggested that the student return to her or his office in the evening for individual help with the term paper. In the moderately harassing condition, the professor suggested that the student visit her or his home later that evening to discuss the paper and the extension, and to enjoy some fine jazz music and wine.

In order to make the videotaped encounters between the professor and student appear more realistic, the student's response to the professor was muted. Suggestions by the professor in the mildly and moderately harassing conditions were sexually suggestive, yet still vague. Therefore, the student's response was somewhat ambiguous as well. When replying positively, the student said, "Yes, I guess that's alright." When replying negatively, the student said, "No, I don't think so. I'll work on my paper alone." In other words, the student did not emphatically respond "yes" or "no," but instead acquiesced or declined in a rather hesitant way.

Questionnaire

After viewing the videotape, participants completed a questionnaire containing items designed to assess "sexuality-based" perceptions, as well as items related to nonverbal communication, the apparent purpose of the experiment. Participants rated how they felt the student and professor were trying to behave with respect to the following traits: flirtatiousness, seductiveness, promiscuity, and sexiness. Perceptions of the following additional traits were also assessed in order to disguise the true nature of the experiment: cheerful, friendly, assertive, considerate, interesting, likable, attractive, warm, intelligent, and sincere. This questionnaire was similar to the one used by Abbey (1982), although she did not include the terms "sexy," "friendly," or "assertive." Approximately half the students evaluated the professor's intentions first, while the other half evaluated the student's intentions first. All ratings were made on 7-point Likert-type scales.

Analyses

Each student viewed a staged interaction between a professor and a student of the other sex and rated each actor on a number of bipolar adjective scales. Their responses to the professor versus the student can be considered a within-subjects factor of target, but the sex of the target is confounded with the status of the target. Although we untangled target sex and target role in this study, it was not possible to separate and directly compare effects due to target sex and target role in a single design. Therefore, two complete sets of analyses were conducted. The first analysis examined the effects of sex of subject, harassment level, student's response, and target role in a $2 \times 3 \times 2 \times 2$ factorial design with repeated measures over the last factor. This analysis was conducted on responses to the dyad involving the male professor and female student (thus, the target role factor represents the ratings of the male professor vs. the female student). The second analysis was identical except that it involved responses to the female professor and male student.

A multivariate analysis of variance (MANOVA) was conducted on the ratings of the four sexual adjectives (sexy, flirtatious, seductive, and promiscuous) and the ratings on the nonsexual terms. The internal consistencies (α) of these ratings were as follows: male professor, $\alpha = .82$; female student, $\alpha = .83$; female professor, $\alpha = .83$; male student, $\alpha = .79$. Univariate analyses of variance (ANOVAs) were conducted on each dependent variable when the multivariate F was significant. Simple main-effect tests and Newman-Keuls post-hoc tests were conducted to interpret univariate interactions and main effects when necessary. For the sake of brevity, only significant effects ($p < .05$) are discussed.

Manipulation checks. A manipulation check was conducted to determine whether the videotaped encounters were perceived to differ in the degree to which they depicted sexual harassment. After they had completed the other dependent measures, 184 students² completed a "harassment scale." The scale provided a definition of sexual harassment and asked five questions regarding the perceived level of harassment that characterized the professor's behavior. Answers were provided on 7-point scales and the internal consistency (coefficient alpha) was .92. After subjects completed all questionnaires, they were told the true purpose of the experiment.

A one-way ANOVA on the harassment-level factor was conducted on students' rating of the professor on the 5-item harassment scale (which was unit-weighted and summed to create an overall index). The harassment level effect was significant for the male professor-female student dyad, $F(2, 92) = 74.48, p < .001, \omega^2 = .61$; and for the female professor-male student dyad $F(2, 87) = 52.90, p < .001, \omega^2 = .56$. In both dyads, students rated the moderately harassing scenarios as potentially more harassing than the mildly harassing scenarios, which were rated as potentially more harassing than the friendly (nonharassing) scenarios.

Friendly and sexy adjectives. Students' ratings of the actors on the 14 friendly and sexual adjectives were the primary dependent variables. A significant Harassment Level $\times$ Target Role interaction provided an additional manipulation check that participants perceived the *professor* (but not the student) as trying to act in a more sexual manner as conditions became more harassing, thus accurately perceiving the harassment level manipulation.

The ratings of the male professor-female student dyad are discussed first. In the full factorial design, a MANOVA Harassment Level $\times$ Target Role interaction was found (Wilks's lambda = .46, $p < .001$). ANOVAs and Newman-Keuls post-hoc tests revealed that the male professor was rated as trying to behave in a *more* flirtatious ($\omega^2 = .39$), seductive ($\omega^2 = .25$), promiscuous ($\omega^2 = .09$), and sexy ($\omega^2 = .11$) manner; and in a *less* considerate ($\omega^2 = .05$), sincere ($\omega^2 = .12$), and likable ($\omega^2 = .04$) manner as the conditions became more harassing. The female student was rated as trying to behave in a less flirtatious and seductive manner as conditions became more harassing.

In the female professor-male student dyad, a significant harassment level MANOVA main effect was observed (Wilks's lambda = .66, $p < .001$). This effect was qualified, however, by a significant Harassment Level $\times$ Target Role MANOVA interaction (Wilks's lambda = .42, $p < .001$). ANOVAs and Newman-Keuls post-hoc tests indicated that the female professor was rated as trying to behave in a *more* flirtatious ($\omega^2 = .42$), seductive ($\omega^2 = .33$), promiscuous ($\omega^2 = .13$), and sexy ($\omega^2 = .16$) way; but in a *less* considerate ($\omega^2 = .09$), sincere ($\omega^2 = .10$), and intelli-

gent ($\omega^2 = .04$) manner as the scenarios depicted greater levels of harassment. Ratings of the male student did not differ across conditions.

RESULTS

Men's Misperceptions

One of the major questions addressed by this study was whether men's misperceptions of cues persist as conditions become more harassing. This question was addressed by examining main effects and interactions involving sex of respondent on the ratings. In the male professor–female student dyad, a significant MANOVA sex of subject main effect emerged (Wilks's lambda = .80, $p < .01$). This effect, however, is qualified by a significant Sex of Subject $\times$ Target Role MANOVA interaction (Wilks's lambda = .71, $p < .01$). The ANOVAs revealed that men, compared to women, rated the *female student* as trying to behave in a more seductive ($\omega^2 = .03$), sexy ($\omega^2 = .07$), promiscuous ($\omega^2 = .02$), and attractive ($\omega^2 = .07$) manner. Women's and men's perceptions of the male professor did not differ.³

In the female professor–male student dyad, a significant MANOVA sex of subject main effect also emerged (Wilks's lambda = .72, $p < .001$). Once again, however, this main effect was qualified by a significant MANOVA Sex of Subject $\times$ Target Role interaction (Wilks's lambda = .82, $p < .05$). The ANOVAs revealed that men, compared to women, rated the *female professor* as trying to behave in a more flirtatious ($\omega^2 = .03$), seductive ($\omega^2 = .05$), and sexy ($\omega^2 = .07$) manner. Men, compared to women, rated the student as trying to behave in a slightly more sexy manner. Therefore, not only did men's differential perceptions of the actors persist over increasing levels of harassment, they also persisted in ratings of the female whether she was in a superior or a subordinate role. The means and standard deviations for these effects are displayed in Table 1.

The harassment level manipulation had one notable effect on women's and men's differential perceptions of the professor–student interaction. In the male professor–female student dyad, a significant MANOVA Sex of Subject $\times$ Harassment Level $\times$ Target Role interaction was found (Wilks's lambda = .69, $p < .01$). ANOVAs revealed significant effects on the terms flirtatious ($\omega^2 = .02$) and sexy ($\omega^2 = .04$). As shown in Table 2, the pattern of mean differences indicated that both men and women perceived the male professor to be acting in a more flirtatious manner as conditions became more harassing. Women's ratings, however, were stronger than men's in the most harassing condition. Women also rated him as trying to behave in a more sexy manner as the scenarios became more harassing. Men's ratings of how sexy the male professor was trying to be in the most harassing condition did not differ from their ratings of

Table 1
Sex of subject $\times$ target role interactions

<i>Role</i>	<i>Male Professor – Female Student Sex of Subject</i>		<i>Female Professor – Male Student Sex of Subject</i>	
	<i>Male</i>	<i>Female</i>	<i>Male</i>	<i>Female</i>
Flirtatious				
Professor	4.26 (1.8)	4.42 (1.9)	4.39 ^b (2.0)	3.45 ^a (2.1)
Student	2.76 (1.5)	2.65 (1.5)	2.22 (1.5)	2.01 (1.5)
Seductive				
Professor	3.74 (2.0)	3.77 (1.9)	4.36 ^b (2.0)	3.16 ^a (1.9)
Student	1.88 (1.2)	1.63 (1.3)	2.85 ^b (1.7)	2.21 ^a (1.4)
Sexy				
Professor	3.54 (2.0)	3.61 (2.0)	4.67 ^b (1.8)	3.25 ^a (1.9)
Student	3.42 ^b (1.9)	2.24 ^a (1.4)	1.80 ^b (1.1)	1.45 ^a (1.0)
Promiscuous				
Professor	4.14 (1.6)	4.14 (1.8)	4.31 (1.6)	3.71 (1.8)
Student	3.69 ^b (1.7)	2.98 ^a (1.7)	3.17 (1.6)	2.55 (1.6)
Attractive				
Professor	4.01 (1.7)	4.20 (1.6)	5.27 (1.6)	4.73 (1.6)
Student	4.75 ^b (1.4)	3.73 ^a (1.7)	2.36 (1.2)	1.99 (1.2)

Note: Different superscripts indicate significantly different pair of means as determined by a Newman-Keuls post-hoc test, $p < .05$. Standard deviations appear in parentheses below the means.

him in the mildly or nonharassing conditions. It appeared that women were particularly sensitive to the male professor's behavior in the most harassing condition. Men's and women's differential ratings of the female student were not consistently affected by the degree of harassment apparent in the scenarios.

Student's Response

The final question addressed by this study concerned the possible effects on respondents' ratings of the student's different responses to the professor's potentially harassing suggestions. The student responded either positively

Table 2
Sex of subject $\times$ role $\times$ harassment level,
male professor-female student dyad

			<i>Harassment Level</i>		
	<i>Sex of Subject</i>	<i>Role</i>	<i>None</i>	<i>Mild</i>	<i>Moderate</i>
Flirtatious	Female	Professor	2.52 ^a (1.5)	4.74 ^b (1.5)	5.74 ^c (1.1)
		Student	3.00 (1.9)	2.50 (1.4)	2.49 (1.1)
	Male	Professor	3.08 ^a (1.6)	4.84 ^b (1.8)	4.71 ^b (1.5)
		Student	3.44 ^b (1.5)	2.40 ^a (1.3)	2.50 ^a (1.5)
	Female	Professor	2.48 ^a (1.33)	3.25 ^a (2.1)	4.83 ^b (1.7)
		Student	2.72 (1.7)	1.93 (1.0)	2.09 (1.3)
Sexy	Male	Professor	2.80 (1.9)	3.93 (2.0)	3.79 (1.8)
		Student	3.44 (2.14)	3.38 (2.0)	3.46 (1.7)

Note: Different superscripts indicate significantly different means per row as determined by a Newman-Keuls post-hoc test, $p < .05$. Standard deviations appear in parentheses below the means.

(but reluctantly) or negatively (but politely) to the professor. No main effects or interactions involving the student's response were found.⁴

DISCUSSION

The purpose of this study was to investigate the robustness and generality of men's misperceptions of mixed-sex interactions to determine whether such misperceptions warrant further attention as psychological processes underlying some of the more common, less severe forms of sexual harassment. Contrary to previous research, gender differences in perceptions were studied in more sexually suggestive situations (as well as in a purely friendly condition), given two different victim responses (accepting or rejecting), and with both women and men in the more powerful social/organizational role.

The results were consistent with previous research suggesting that men tend to view interpersonal interactions in more sexual terms than women (Abbey, 1982; Abbey & Melby, 1986; Saal et al., 1989). Regardless of the harassment condition and the response of the victim, male respondents rated the actors in more sexual terms than did females, with one exception

(a male professor). Specifically, men more than women believed that the female actor, whether she portrayed the student or the professor, was trying to behave in a more promiscuous, seductive, and sexy manner, and they believed that the male student was trying to act in a more sexy manner.

The major inconsistency between the results of this study and research that has only examined friendly interactions was the finding that, in the most harassing condition, women viewed the male professor in *more* sexual terms (sexy and flirtatious) than men. Contrary to the results of Scotland and Craig (1988), in which both men and women were able to distinguish flirtatious from friendly behavior, our findings suggest that men are less likely than women to differentiate between the sexual intentions of a more severe male harasser and those of a less severe one. In typical instances of sexual harassment, where the man is the perpetrator, this gender difference in perceptions may be operative. In this case, women appear to be particularly sensitized to the sexual aspects of the situation.

The general lack of any significant effects (main effects or interactions) due to the students' responses to the potentially harassing suggestions must be interpreted carefully. The lack of any effect due to response could mean that regardless of how the student responds, men tend to view the behavior of the professor and the student in more sexual terms than women. The sex of subject main effect on the sexually based adjectives indicates that even when the student refused to submit to the professor's potentially most harassing behavior, men persisted in rating the student as trying to act in a more sexual manner than did women—especially with the female student. This certainly speaks to the generality and robustness of men's (mis)perceptions of interpersonal cues.

This finding must be viewed with caution, however. In order to make the videotaped encounters between the professor and student appear realistic, the operationalization of the student's response was somewhat muted. Because the student did not emphatically respond "yes" or "no" to the professor's suggestions, this manipulation may not have been strong enough to enable respondents to detect a difference in response. This does suggest, however, that mild refusals and reluctant acceptances are not perceived differently.

Past studies of misperceptions of friendly cues have examined interactions between women and men in equal-status roles (Abbey, 1982; Saal et al., 1989) or with the male actor in a higher status role compared to the female actor (Saal et al., 1989). The interpretation of men's misperceptions of women's intentions is troubling, especially in the latter condition. Do men interpret a subordinate female's behavior as a potential sexual come-on because she is female or because she is in a lower status role (student or employee)? The present study was designed to untangle this confound by presenting situations in which both female and male actors

portrayed superior (professor) and subordinate (student) roles. A direct comparison of men's and women's ratings of the female actor as a professor versus the female actor as a student was not possible given the limitations of the experimental design. The patterns of effects for both professor-student dyads could be examined, however.

With some exceptions, perceptions of the male professor-female student dyad were similar to those of the female professor-male student dyad. Both professors were seen by all respondents as trying to behave in a more sexual manner as the interactions became more harassing. The response to the professor's harassment (acceptance or rejection) did not affect ratings of sexual attributes of either the male or the female actor. The few exceptions to these parallel sets of findings involve two different interactions. First, the Sex of Subject $\times$ Target Role interaction indicated that men's sexually based ratings of the female student were elevated compared to women's ratings. Except for using the term "sexy," men's sexually based perceptions of the male student did not differ from women's perceptions. This suggests that men misperceive women's behavior, not men's. Second, the Sex of Subject $\times$ Harassment Level $\times$ Target Role interaction, which indicated that women's sexually based perceptions of the professor were heightened compared to men's in the most harassing condition, was found only in the male professor-female student dyad. This may suggest that women are not quite as sensitive to the harassing behavior of other women as they are to the harassing behavior of men (or that, perhaps, such behavior is perceived as phenomenologically different and was not measured in this study).

To summarize, this study adds to the generality and robustness of the finding that men are more likely than women to misperceive women's interpersonal behavior. The ratings of men and women differ not only when a female is subordinate in a relationship, but also when she is superior. Furthermore, men's misperceptions of women's behavior persist over increasing levels of harassment with few exceptions. Perhaps most important, men's misperceptions persist regardless of whether the student accepts or rejects the professor's advances. The female student's effort to politely refuse the professor's (potentially) harassing suggestion did not alter men's heightened, sexually based perceptions of her. Future research should examine just how strong her refusal must be to eliminate men's misperceptions.

This study did not, however, establish any links between men's (or women's) tendency to misperceive interpersonal behavior and *actual* sexual harassment. That is, we are not able to conclude that "misperceivers" are more likely to sexually harass others compared to "nonmisperceivers." Recently, Stockdale and Saal (1990) and Saal (1990) have begun to examine the relationship between misperceptions as an individual-difference variable and condoning or tolerating sexually harassing behavior. They found that for both women and men, sexually based perceptions of a

woman's friendly behavior in one circumstance were positively related to approval ratings of harassing behavior in other circumstances. Future research should examine whether misperceivers have a higher threshold for labeling behavior as harassment (e.g., Kenig & Ryan, 1986), whether they may contribute to a "chilly climate" for women (Hall, 1982), or whether they are more likely to aid an accused harasser rather than an alleged victim (see Saal, 1990). Ultimately, we must demonstrate whether misperceivers are more likely than nonmisperceivers to sexually harass another person.

The study of misperceptions in the context of sexual harassment should also include an examination of antecedents such as personality variables (e.g., need for power, need for dominance, Machiavellianism), attitudinal variables (e.g., sex-role orientation, attitudes toward women), and organizational factors (sex ratios of working groups; see Gutek, 1985; and organizational structure and climate; see Kanter, 1977). A comprehensive model of sexual harassment must consider all these variables in order to further our understanding of this important phenomenon. This research suggests that misperceptions are robust, generalized phenomena that warrant further investigation as components of such a model.

NOTES

1. The use of the labels "none," "mild," and "moderate" merely denotes the progressive levels of harassment behavior. The authors recognize that what one person views as "mild" harassment may be viewed as "moderately" or "extremely" harassing to another.
2. The authors decided to include this manipulation check after half the data had been collected. Therefore, only a subset of the entire sample provided responses to these questions.
3. Except as revealed by the 3-way interaction with harassment level, which will be discussed later.
4. The target role main effect is not presented here. The multivariate target role main effect was significant. The ANOVAs revealed that subjects rated the professor higher or lower than the student on several terms which confirms that subjects perceived the professor differently than they perceived the student. The main effect alone is not important for the purposes of this study; therefore, it is not discussed. A full report of these affects is available from the authors.

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